

Channel Sales — AI Activation Marathon

Facilitator briefer & talk track · Aug 3 – Sep 21 · Mon–Thu optional (15–20 min) · Friday mandatory · AI Drop-Ins Mon & Thu 11:00–11:45 EST

PART 1 · THE ZOOMED-OUT VIEW — WHAT EACH WEEK SKILLS UP

Five weeks, five AI capability areas. Before the day-by-day detail, this is the skilling arc at week level.

W1 · Rewire Your Thinking

Aug 3–7

AI fluency & prompt mastery

Moves the team from using AI as a search box to using it as a thinking partner. The week builds the habits everything else depends on: directing AI to challenge you, making it model an audience before writing, forcing it to critique its own output, and working backwards from great output to great input. The skill being built is not any one prompt — it is control of the conversation with AI.

W2 · Partner Intelligence

Aug 10–14

AI-powered research & decision intelligence

Applies that control to the recruit stage of the partner lifecycle. The capability area is decision intelligence: multi-source research synthesis, counter-analysis so conclusions are earned rather than assumed, auditable reasoning, and turning scattered experience into explicit decision frameworks. By Friday the team can produce decision-ready partner intelligence, not just information.

W3 · Partner Activation

Aug 17–21

AI as an enablement engine

Shifts from analysis to construction. The capability area is generating structured business systems with AI: onboarding plans designed against their own failure modes, multi-part learning journeys, and external signals converted into commercial next moves — then assembling separate outputs into one deployable package. This is where AI stops writing text and starts building programs.

W4 · Partner Business Review

Aug 24–28

AI-assisted analytics & executive storytelling

The summit week. The capability area is full-stack: reading business data with pattern recognition and benchmark skepticism, engineering predictive quality criteria, designing a go-to-market strategy with resistance modeling, and compressing all of it into an executive narrative rehearsed under pressure. It converges in one Partner Business Review — the Grand Final entry.

W5 · Bonus Week

Aug 31–Sep 4

Hands-on building & formal credentialing

Consolidation, by choice: build a real tool with AI coding agents and ship it to a live URL (capstone), or convert marathon momentum into a recognized credential via a LinkedIn Learning AI course or certification — with coaching to pick the right one. Or simply catch up; all completions count.

PART 2 · THE TALK TRACK

Written to be spoken — roughly 5–6 minutes at a natural pace. Italic lines are delivery notes, not script.

Opening

“Team — over the next five weeks we’re running the AI Activation Marathon. Before you picture another training program, let me reset that: this isn’t about learning what AI is. Every single activity takes something you **already do** in channel sales — pitching, qualifying partners, onboarding, running business reviews — and shows you where AI fits into it. Fifteen to twenty minutes a day, Monday to Thursday, all optional. Friday is the one that counts — one mandatory submission a week, posted in the channel. That’s the whole ask.”

WEEK 1 Rewire Your Thinking AUG 3–7 · PROMPTING

“Week one is about breaking the habit of using AI like a search engine. Most people ask AI a question, get an answer, copy, paste, done. This week teaches you to use it as a **thinking partner** — and there are four distinct ways to do that.

Monday, you take a real partner pitch and tell AI to attack it — play a skeptical partner exec who finds your three weakest claims and refuses to be polite about it. That’s the opportunity: AI as your toughest critic before the real meeting, not your cheerleader after it.

Tuesday, one message, three readers — a partner CEO, a partner AE, a customer IT director. But you make AI profile each reader **first** — what they care about, what they fear — and let the profile drive the writing.

Wednesday you use AI to make something genuinely complex — Fabric, interconnection — simple **without making it wrong**, by having AI critique its own analogies. Thursday you flip the whole thing: take a piece of excellent writing and ask AI what prompt would have produced it. That’s how you build prompts you can reuse forever.

Friday brings it together: one messy, real channel situation, and you run all four modes on it. What you walk away with isn’t a document — it’s a repeatable way of thinking with AI.”

WEEK 2 Partner Intelligence AUG 10–14 · CHECKPOINT: RECRUIT

“Week two, we point all of that at the recruit stage of the partner lifecycle. The theme is: stop taking AI’s first answer.

Monday you run a partner-fit assessment — but you push it: what makes them great with Equinix, what makes them a bad fit, what would a competitor offer them, what would make you walk away. The opportunity here is research that argues **both sides**, so your verdict is earned, not assumed. Tuesday you build the five-minute first-call brief, then stress-test it — what question would this prospect ask that the brief can’t answer? Close that gap. Wednesday, a positioning statement where AI has to **explain its reasoning** so you can audit it — that’s how you use AI for judgment calls without surrendering the judgment. Thursday, you build your ideal partner profile for your territory — the attributes that predict success, the red flags that predict churn. Think beyond revenue: vertical expertise, new-logo access, deal quality, financial strength.

Friday: one complete recruitment intelligence brief on one prospect — fit, first-call plan, route-to-market, and the three questions that decide pursuit. Executive-readable, one to two pages. That’s a real artifact you could hand your leader on Monday.”

WEEK 3 Partner Activation AUG 17–21 · CHECKPOINT: ONBOARD & ENABLE

“Week three moves to onboarding and enablement — the stage where partnerships quietly die if you get it wrong.

Monday you draft a 30-60-90 for a new partner — but the AI opportunity is making it **anticipate failure**: where do new partners typically stall, and what’s the counter-move you build in upfront? Tuesday, AI reviews an engagement plan the way a coach would — pulling out risks and telling you what a great partner manager does on the next call. Wednesday you design a full learning journey for a new partner — sales, technical pre-sales,

marketing — the kind of structured, multi-part content that used to take days. Thursday, AI scans the last seven days of industry news for your partner segment and you push it to find one thing — which item creates a co-sell opening **this quarter**. News in, next move out.

Friday you assemble everything into one Partner Launch Pack — a package a new partner manager could literally run with on day one.”

WEEK 4 Partner Business Review AUG 24–28 · CHECKPOINT: GTM & EXECUTION · GRAND FINAL ENTRY

Slow down here — this is the big one; it carries the incentive.

“Week four is the summit. Everything converges into a Partner Business Review — and I want you to hear this part clearly: **Friday’s PBR is your Grand Final entry**. No separate deliverable. Your best work this week is your ticket.

The week mirrors how a great PBR actually works. Monday: truth — you diagnose a deal-registration funnel with AI, and you learn the most important data skill there is: making AI tell you what context it needs **before** you trust a number. Twenty percent quarter-over-quarter growth — good or bad? It depends, and AI should ask on what. Tuesday: diagnosis — define what a high-quality pipeline actually looks like and build screening logic that keeps noise out without discouraging partners. Wednesday: the plan — design one GTM motion end to end, then pressure-test it: who ignores this motion, and what changes their mind? Thursday: delivery — rewrite it all in executive language, then have AI **roleplay the partner exec** and hit you with the three hardest questions before a human ever does.

Friday, the Full PBR: what happened, why, and what next. Judged on story clarity, insight quality, lifecycle alignment, executive readiness, and AI craft. The winner presents at the EMEA Partner Sales All Hands on September 21st — in front of everyone.”

WEEK 5 Bonus Week AUG 31–SEP 4 · CAPSTONE · COURSE/CERT · OR CATCH UP

“Then week five is yours — three ways to spend it. Build a capstone: a vibe-coding sprint with AI coding agents where you ship a real tool — a dashboard, an app, something your role actually needs — to a live URL, with live build sessions at the Drop-Ins. Or complete a LinkedIn Learning AI course or certification — we’ll help you pick the right one. Or honestly? Just catch up on anything you missed. All completions count.”

Close

“Housekeeping: Drop-In sessions Mondays and Thursdays, eleven to eleven forty-five Eastern — Joseph and I will be there for anything: activities, capstone, PBR help. One rule with no exceptions: anything proprietary — Equinix data, customer information — stays in Copilot, ACE, or SideKick. Synthetic and public data can go anywhere.

Here’s the arc in one line: week one changes how you **think** with AI. Weeks two through four apply it across the partner lifecycle — recruit, activate, review. And it all lands on one PBR good enough for the biggest stage we have. Come, learn, play, build, share. The site’s live — first activity drops Monday, August 3rd.”